LESSON 9

The Surprise

From Haydn's "Surprise" Symphony: a quiet tune, played again even quieter… then a loud chord to wake everyone up.

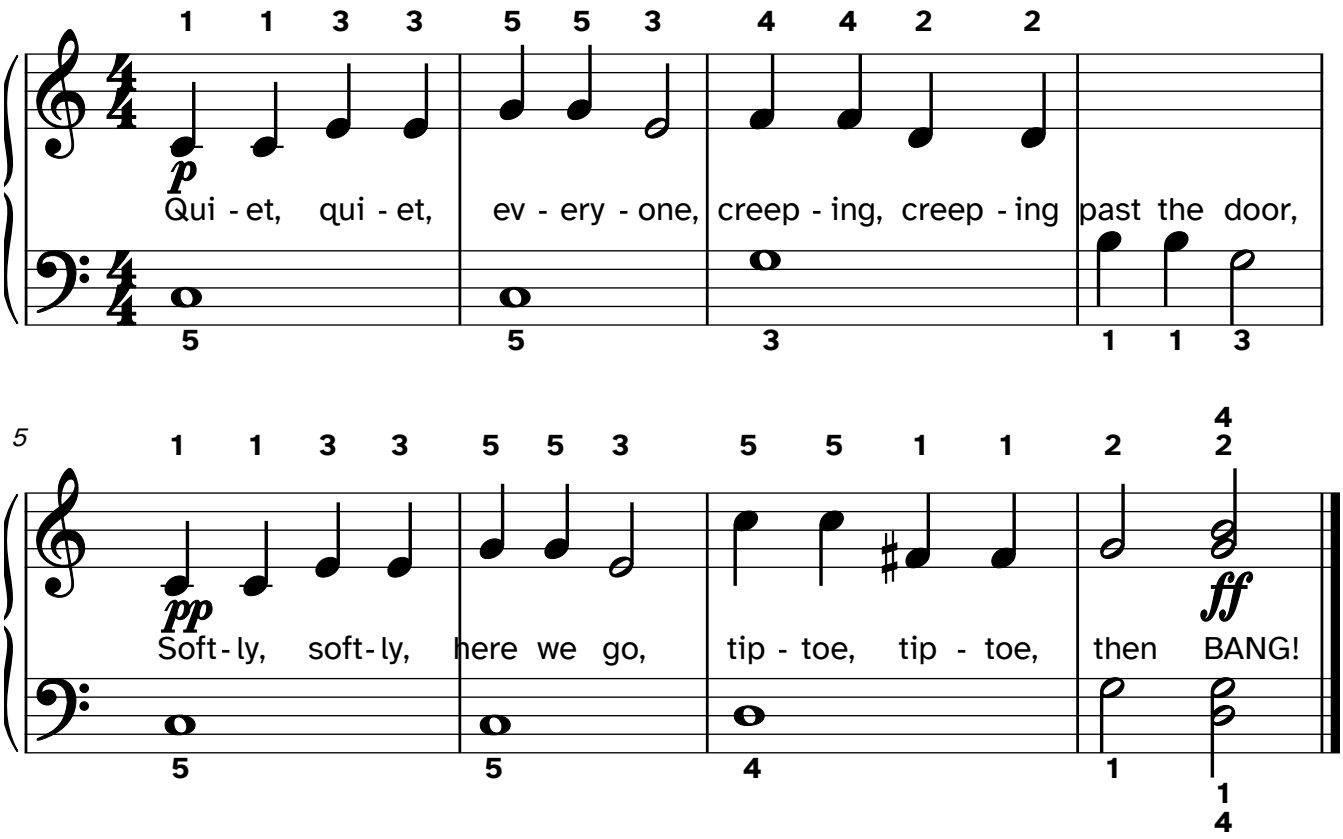
IN THIS SONG **the left hand answers** **F sharp: a black key** **p and ff: soft and BANG**

LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen to the whole song once, then hum along the second time.

1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing. Sing it soft, then very soft… then BANG! Then play it: the left hand answers in bar 4.

Right hand: the C position; in bar 7 it moves up: thumb on F♯, 5 on the high C. **Left hand:** 5 on the low C for the roots; in bars 3–4 it moves up two keys (thumb on B) and answers *past the door* just under middle C.



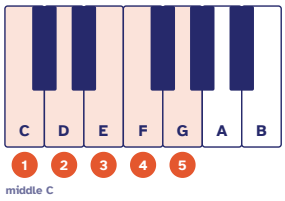
THE WOW MOMENT
☆ **The surprise:** Haydn wrote it for listeners who dozed off. Play the second half as softly as a whisper… then BANG: a G chord with both hands!

☐ **Listened and pointed** ☐ **Played the soft and the very soft** ☐ **Made the BANG**

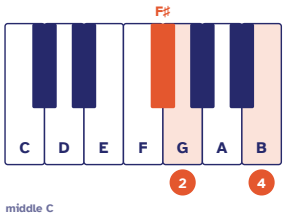
2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

RIGHT HAND · C POSITION



BAR 7 · THUMB ON F♯, 5 ON HIGH C



NEW IN THIS SONG

F♯: the black key just right of F, F's best friend. **p** soft, **pp** very soft, **ff** very loud. **Hands move:** the left hand up for its answer, the right hand up for the high C.

THE RHYTHM

Say it in time, then clap and count: clap on coral, hold on grey, lift on a rest.

THE TIME

4/4

Top 4: four beats in every bar.

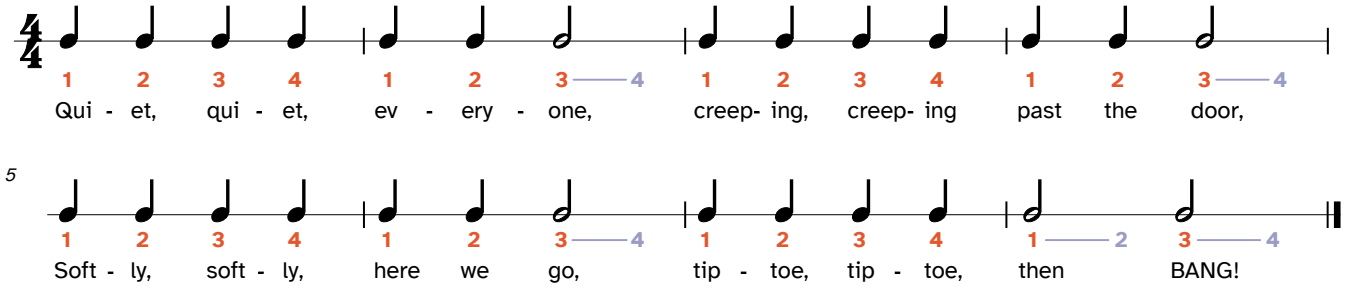
Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

THE NOTES

crotchet: walk — 1 beat ●

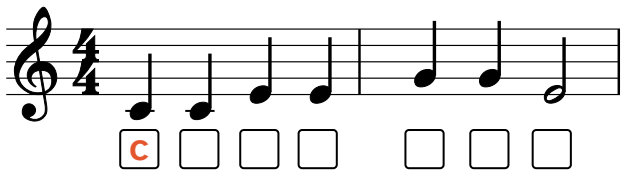
crotchet rest: knock — 1 beat ●

minim: hold — 2 beats ●●

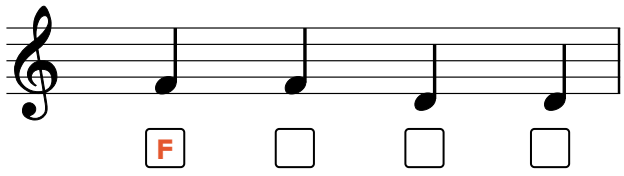


THE NOTES

Write each letter. ♯ in front: the black key just to the right. Write F♯.



3



SPOT THE MISTAKE Your teacher plays F for F♯, or loud for soft. Put up your hand when you hear it.

☐ **Said it in time** ☐ **Clapped it** ☐ **Wrote the letters** ☐ **Spotted the mistake**

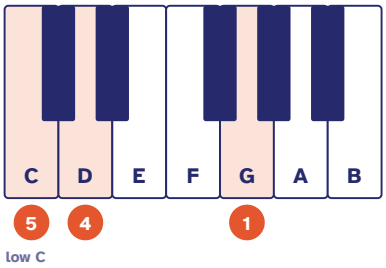
3 The roots

Roots C, G and D under the left hand; in bars 3–4 it moves up to answer, then comes home.

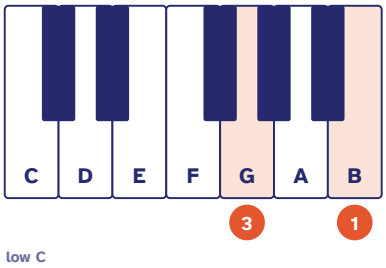
MEET THE ROOTS

Home: 5 on low C (C 5, D 4, G 1). For the answer it moves up two keys: G 3, B 1.

LEFT HAND · HOME, 5 ON LOW C

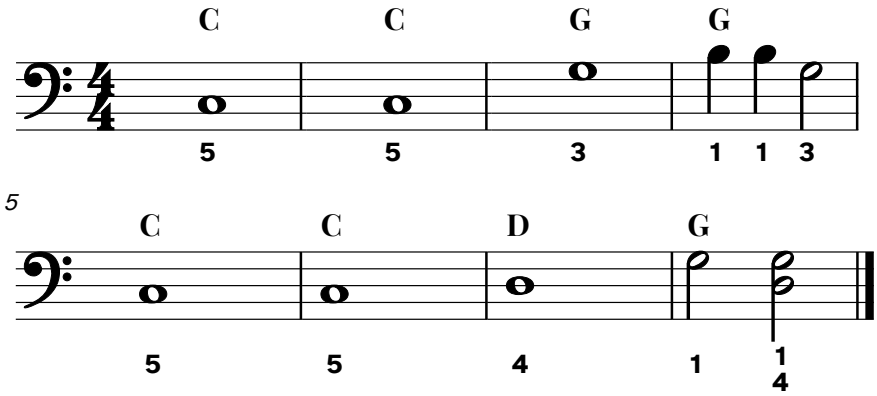


BARS 3–4 · THUMB ON B



THE ROOTS, WITH THEIR NAMES

The left hand's part on its own: the roots, the answer in bar 4, and the BANG.



PLAY FROM THE NAMES

Only the names now. Play each bar's root and hold it while the band plays the tune.

C	C	G	G
C	C	D	G

4 · CHECK

I can play it: colour a step each time you climb

	Slowly	Steady	With the band	Fast
From the notes				
From the names				

TEACHER ☐ **Pass** ☐ **Not yet**

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways, then take a first look at the next lesson.

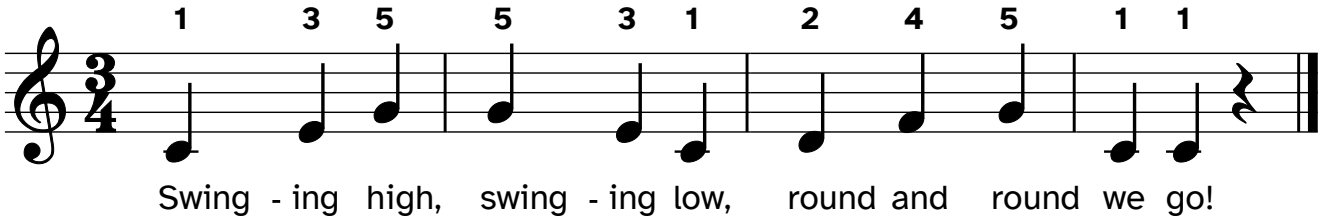
SNEAKY CAT

Tiptoe music: 4 slides onto the black key and back, like a cat creeping.



SWING SONG

A peek at Lesson 10: three beats in a bar. Lean on beat 1, like a swing.



MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole song that way. Can your teacher guess which?

- ☐ **The other way round: very soft first, then soft**
- ☐ **Two bangs at the end**
- ☐ **Up high: an octave higher**

5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the song once
2. Right hand alone, soft and very soft
3. Both hands, with the band
4. Your choice: a tune from this page

☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

☐ **Played Sneaky Cat** ☐ **Played Swing Song**